

Strengthening and Weakening

Q1 Indoor residential environments have a direct influence on human health, especially considering that in developing countries, significant levels of indoor pollution make dwellings unsafe, which has an impact on the health of the inhabitants. Evidence also exists of associations with low birth weight, increased infant and perinatal mortality, pulmonary tuberculosis, nasopharyngeal and laryngeal cancer, cataracts, and, specifically in respect of the use of coal, with lung cancer. The authorities are on the lookout for solutions related to indoor residential environments

Identify the appropriate strengthening statement that supports the author in the given paragraph

- (A) Housing is, therefore, a key factor influencing the health of people around the world; however, other factors like transport should also be considered when discovering environmental hazards
- (B) A serious condition can result from the misapplication of these parameters.
- (C) Housing accommodations are safe environments that protect human health
- (D) Various parameters such as air quality, and ventilation, indoors can contribute to a healthy environment
- (E) The impact of indoor pollution on human health is negligible and there is no concrete evidence linking it to adverse health effects.

Q2 The advancements in artificial intelligence (AI) will disrupt the global labor market, with predictions that 50% of existing jobs could be

replaced by automation and AI technologies within the next two decades. It has been identified that sectors such as manufacturing, transportation, and customer service as particularly vulnerable to job losses due to the rapid adoption of AI-driven automation. “AI is likely to transform rather than eliminate jobs” is just a cover, as new roles require specialized skills and investment of resources in AI management, cybersecurity, and data analysis, which not every country can afford. Furthermore, many countries and organizations need to heavily invest in workforce upskilling and reskilling programs to prepare employees for an AI-driven economy. Which statement most effectively weakens the claim of the argument presented by the author?

- (A) AI has already demonstrated its ability to outperform humans in routine tasks, especially in manufacturing and logistics.
- (B) Many governments and organizations want to invest in upskilling and reskilling programs to equip workers with AI skills, but not many can afford it.
- (C) The adoption of AI technologies in almost all kinds of economies remains slow due to high costs and limited infrastructure.
- (D) The healthcare sector is increasingly using AI for diagnostics and patient management, reducing the reliance on traditional labor.
- (E) AI's application is prevalent in almost all industries and has a massive impact on employment sectors, that are facing constant inconsistencies.

Q3



A comprehensive academic study analyzed the impact of remote work on employee productivity across 50 organizations from diverse industries over a three-year period. The findings indicate that employees working remotely reported higher levels of productivity due to fewer workplace distractions, such as unnecessary meetings or office politics. They also expressed improved work-life balance, citing flexible schedules and the ability to spend more time with family. Opponents of remote work argue that physical proximity in traditional office setups encourages better team dynamics and creativity, especially in industries requiring high levels of collaboration. Despite this, organizations that implemented robust remote work policies—such as clear communication protocols and virtual team-building activities—reported a net gain in productivity metrics compared to pre-remote work levels.

Which statement best supports the claim that remote work improves productivity?

- (A) Employees working remotely often struggle with isolation and reduced team interaction, which may lower their motivation; but good ethics and company culture can help them deal with such issues.
- (B) Organizations with effective remote work policies have seen improved productivity due to fewer workplace distractions and better work-life balance.
- (C) The lack of monitoring tools has created challenges in maintaining productivity among remote employees; new technologies and company policies can eliminate such hurdles.
- (D) In-person collaboration is essential for industries dependent on teamwork, making traditional office setups more effective.
- (E) The transition to remote work has been primarily driven by cost-cutting measures and its influential impact on productivity.

Q4 A recent study found that students who take handwritten notes during lectures retain more

information than those who type their notes on a laptop. The researchers argue that handwriting helps students better process and understand the material, leading to improved memory retention.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the researchers' argument?

- (A) Students who take handwritten notes tend to review their notes more frequently than those who type them.
- (B) Many students prefer typing notes because it is faster and allows them to capture more information.
- (C) Some subjects, such as mathematics and chemistry, require diagrams that are easier to draw by hand than on a laptop.
- (D) Laptops can be used for multiple purposes, such as browsing the internet or sending emails during class.
- (E) Some students who type their notes perform just as well as those who write by hand on memory-based tests.

Q5 A new study suggests that urban green spaces significantly improve the mental health of city residents. The researchers measured stress levels and happiness in individuals before and after they spent time in parks. While the study reported a noticeable improvement in mood, some critics argue that the results could be attributed to participants engaging in physical activity rather than the environment itself. Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument that urban green spaces improve mental health?

- (A) Urban green spaces were rated as more effective in improving mood than non-urban natural settings, such as forests.
- (B) Stress reduction was more pronounced in urban green spaces compared to indoor recreational facilities with equivalent activities.
- (C) The study controlled for external factors such as diet, sleep patterns, and daily routines to



isolate the impact of green spaces.

- (D) Participants consistently reported feeling more relaxed and less stressed in green spaces, regardless of physical activity levels.
- (E) Participants who engaged in non-physical activities, such as reading or meditating in green spaces, reported similar mood improvements.

Q6 Proponents of universal basic income (UBI) argue that it can eliminate poverty by providing financial security to all citizens, regardless of employment status. Critics, however, claim that UBI could discourage people from seeking work, thereby reducing overall productivity and increasing dependency on government aid. Which of the following, if true, most weakens the argument against UBI?

- (A) Long-term studies reveal that UBI recipients often use their financial stability to pursue education and skill development.
- (B) Regions implementing UBI have shown no significant changes in unemployment rates compared to those without it.
- (C) UBI reduces administrative overhead costs compared to maintaining traditional welfare systems.
- (D) Recipients of UBI report higher life satisfaction and lower stress levels, regardless of employment status.
- (E) Data indicates that UBI recipients are more likely to start entrepreneurial ventures than those relying on conventional welfare.

Q7 Governments dominated water management throughout the twentieth century. Tasked with ensuring a public supply of clean, safe, reliable, and affordable water, governmental agencies-controlled water administration in most of the world. They built dams, reservoirs, and aqueducts that store water when available and move that water to areas with increasing populations and economies.

Private businesses sometimes played a part in managing water, but typically in a supporting position as consultants or contractors. Today, given the global need for innovative new technologies, institutions, and financing to solve the freshwater crisis, private businesses and markets are playing a rapidly expanding role, bringing both new approaches and new challenges to a historically public field. Which of the following statements strengthens the conclusion related to water management from the above passage?

- (A) Private businesses have now collaborated with governments to participate in water management by looking into major infrastructure and providing equipment and maintenance services.
- (B) The role of private businesses in water management is magnanimous, as their contributions are more related to technical support rather than assuming a leadership role.
- (C) Private businesses have now taken over governments and dominate water management by controlling major infrastructure and providing equipment and maintenance services.
- (D) The global freshwater crisis has necessitated greater involvement from the private sector, and it is their responsibility to ensure a clean and affordable water supply.
- (E) Private businesses, due to their expertise in new technologies and financing, have become essential players in water management.

Q8 A company introduced a new policy allowing employees to take short breaks every hour to walk or stretch. After six months, a survey showed that employees who followed this practice reported higher productivity and lower stress levels compared to those who did not. The company concluded that taking regular short breaks improves both productivity and well-being.



Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the company's conclusion?

- (A) Employees who took regular short breaks completed tasks faster and made fewer mistakes than those who did not.
- (B) Some employees preferred to work without taking breaks and still reported high productivity.
- (C) Other companies with similar break policies have not reported the same level of improvement in productivity.
- (D) Employees who followed the new break policy spent less time working overall than those who did not.
- (E) The survey was conducted only among employees who volunteered to participate.

Q9 This diversity of meanings has prompted some people to question the usefulness of the word. Some have doubted whether it is even a proper concept or more a fancy way of saying that a lot of things are going on. In his article for Vox online earlier this year, the US political journalist Daniel Drezner notes how, to some, it sounds like 'a confusing and redundant neologism' and quotes the historian Niall Ferguson's quip at Davos that it is 'just history happening'. The background assumption seems to be that, in order for a word to be worthy, its meaning must be clear and distinct. But this misses a crucial thing about how words work. They are always wanton, impossible to rein in.

Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the premise of the given paragraph?

- (A) Scholars from various fields agree that the term's multiple meanings make it versatile and applicable in diverse contexts.
- (B) A linguistic analysis reveals that the term has been historically used in inconsistent ways, contributing to miscommunication.
- (C) Public polls show that a majority of people feel confident in their understanding of the

term and its applications.

- (D) Several prominent thought leaders have criticized the term for lacking precision, often likening it to vague generalizations.
- (E) The term has been extensively defined in academic literature, with clear distinctions between its various usages.

Q10 Peer support draws upon a fundamental human instinct to relate and connect with the other's condition. As human beings, we are imbued with an innate potential to not only listen to others' stories but, through such engaged listening, support them in coping and overcoming emotional and psychological distress. When someone listens to us in this way, with empathy and respect, we feel recognised. A sense of recognition not only validates and affirms our emotional pain, but also helps foster hope and resilience to cope with adversity.

In the context of the paragraph, which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the assumption that peer support harnesses the innate human potential for recognizing and validating emotional pain?

- (A) Individuals experiencing peer support report higher level of emotional recognitions.
- (B) The basic human instinct connect is limited to verbal communication specifically.
- (C) Peer support involves providing solution and advice rather than just empathy and respect.
- (D) The emotional distress faced by individuals is exclusively dependent on external factors and not by interpersonal relationships.
- (E) Peer support has been shown to foster resilience through non-verbal cues and body language recognition.

Q11 A city's public transportation department plans to replace its diesel-powered buses with electric buses. Officials argue that this switch will significantly reduce air pollution in the city, as electric buses do not produce exhaust emissions like diesel buses.



Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the officials' argument?

- (A) The electricity used to charge the electric buses comes from renewable energy sources, such as wind and solar power.
- (B) Electric buses are more expensive to purchase than diesel buses, increasing initial costs for the city.
- (C) Many cities that have switched to electric buses have seen an increase in ridership.
- (D) Diesel buses can be retrofitted with better filters to reduce their emissions.
- (E) Some electric buses require frequent charging, which can disrupt public transportation schedules.

Q12 The advent of the nuclear age had transformed peace into the perpetual preparation for war, and, in an interesting reversal of Carl von Clausewitz's dictum that war is a continuation of politics by other means, threatened to cancel politics altogether by ensuring the mutual destruction of the belligerents. Anders deplored tacticians' and politicians' collective blindness, their unconsciousness in seeking to instrumentalise the threat of annihilation for political purposes – a gamble that relied on their very ignorance.

What, if true, would most bolster the argument that Anders criticized the collective blindness of tacticians and politicians during the nuclear age for political gain?

- (A) Political leaders intentionally downplayed the consequences of nuclear conflict that underestimated the potential for mutual destruction.
- (B) Carl von Clausewitz's dictum became a guiding principle for many political and military leaders during the nuclear age.
- (C) Anders actively engaged in diplomatic efforts to promote international cooperation in nuclear disarmament.
- (D) The nuclear age witnessed an increase in global collaboration aimed at preventing the

escalation of conflicts into nuclear warfare.

- (E) The threat of nuclear annihilation led to a significant decrease in military spending and arms development worldwide.

Q13 Advocates for artificial intelligence (AI) in healthcare claim that it can drastically improve diagnostic accuracy and reduce costs. For instance, machine-learning algorithms have demonstrated higher accuracy in detecting early-stage cancers compared to traditional methods. However, skeptics argue that the over-reliance on AI may lead to errors if human oversight is removed.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the advocates' claim?

- (A) Independent studies confirm that AI-assisted diagnostics result in fewer false negatives and false positives compared to traditional methods.
- (B) AI systems can continuously learn and improve their diagnostic accuracy by analyzing large datasets over time.
- (C) Hospitals integrating AI have reported significant cost savings while maintaining or improving patient outcomes.
- (D) Machine-learning algorithms are more consistent in applying diagnostic criteria compared to human experts.
- (E) The use of AI in healthcare has led to earlier detection of diseases, resulting in better patient prognoses and reduced treatment costs.

Q14 With the rapid development of 3D acquisition, 3D data can be efficiently captured from the real world or created with easy-to-use modeling software. Furthermore, recent advances in Internet tools, especially online repositories, allowed shapes to be shared among users. As a result, 3D shapes are largely available nowadays and have been widely used for important applications such as entertainment and games,



robotics and autonomous systems, and virtual and augmented reality.

Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) Concurrently, there is an explosive growth of data which has significantly enhanced the power of modern computational devices
- (B) Building and benchmarking 3D shape datasets, irrespective of how time-consuming and expensive it is, has also become particularly important
- (C) Deep learning based on large-scale neural networks has become an active research area and a fundamental technique in computer vision and computer graphics.
- (D) Following the excellent results of applying deep learning to 2D images, researchers have also adopted deep learning for 3D shape understanding and processing.
- (E) The accessibility of 3D data through online repositories and easy-to-use modeling software has democratized the creation and sharing of 3D shapes, fostering innovation and collaboration across various fields.

- Q15** The contributions of gravel and sand to the construction industry are well known for their uses in concrete production. However, the supply and scarcity of sand and gravel at reasonable rates are currently a concern for the construction sector. Natural aggregates are generally extracted from natural sources, leading to significant environmental problems brought on by deforestation and the collection of natural aggregates from river bottoms, lakes, and other water bodies, as well as the crushing of quarry rock and larger boulders.

Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) This scenario has drawn the concern of relevant authorities and not much research is done on it.
- (B) Many countries are finding substitutes for conventional natural aggregates that can be

used in concrete and have similar properties.

- (C) Green constructionism is being adopted in the construction industry to limit risks to human health
- (D) The supply and scarcity of sand and gravel at reasonable rates are a concern for the construction sector
- (E) The construction industry is exploring alternative materials and innovative techniques to mitigate the environmental impact of natural aggregate extraction and address the concerns of supply scarcity.

- Q16** A new health study claims that drinking two cups of green tea daily significantly reduces the risk of heart disease. Researchers argue that the antioxidants in green tea help protect the heart by reducing inflammation and improving blood circulation.

Which of the following, if true, most weakens the researchers' argument?

- (A) Some individuals may be allergic to certain compounds found in green tea.
- (B) Green tea contains caffeine, which can temporarily raise heart rate.
- (C) The study was conducted on a small group of participants over just six months.
- (D) Many people drink green tea for its calming effects rather than its health benefits.
- (E) Research was conducted on the athletes who consumed green tea

- Q17** Environmentalists claim that reducing plastic packaging in grocery stores will significantly lower plastic waste and benefit the environment. However, a survey revealed that many consumers who buy products with reduced packaging tend to use plastic bags at checkout at much higher rates. Additionally, manufacturers have begun replacing plastic packaging with heavier alternatives, which require more energy to produce and transport.



Which of the following most weakens the environmentalists' claim?

- (A) Grocery stores that use reduced packaging often provide discounts, encouraging more frequent purchases.
- (B) The energy required to produce alternative packaging materials may exceed the environmental costs of plastic packaging.
- (C) Consumers are more likely to recycle plastic packaging than heavier alternatives.
- (D) The amount of plastic bags used by consumers has a greater environmental impact than plastic packaging.
- (E) Many grocery items with reduced packaging are not properly protected, leading to higher rates of food waste.

Q18 In the conditions of transformative transformations, the need to increase the quality level of the institutional foundations of state financial control, considering foreign experience, is increasing. It is expedient to improve the approaches to determining the priority directions for the development of state financial control, which will contribute to strengthening the level of manageability of the state finance system. Thus, financial and legal mechanisms are most relevant for exposing corruption in public (municipal) procurement at the stage of procurement procedure cost development. It is at the stage when the initial maximum price is set when dishonest customers intentionally raise prices to receive maximum profit from the supplier.

Identify the appropriate strengthening statement that supports the author in the given paragraph

- (A) The essence of the institutional foundations of the development of state financial control in the conditions of social transformation is questioned
- (B) The mechanisms of the functioning of state financial control as a component of the state

finance management system have been demerited.

- (C) Rather than focusing on state financial control, it is essential to rely on nationwide policies that can otherwise help not only states but other parts of the country as well.
- (D) State financial control has no significant impact on the manageability of the state finance system.
- (E) State financial control further leads to the development of the provision on increasing the level of efficiency in the use of budget funds.

Q19 At present, the idea of river management tends to be diversified, aiming at seeking solutions to quickly respond to sudden water pollution incidents and effective management of water environment deterioration, and gradually shifting the focus to the analysis and control of pollution sources. Agricultural non-point source pollution is one of the main factors leading to river ecological environment problems. Among them, the tailwater of farmland carries a large number of nutrients and pesticide residues without any treatment, which enters the river channel in various ways and seriously damages the river ecosystem. According to the investigation by the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO), nearly half of the irrigation water will eventually enter the underground aquifers and rivers, and the resulting agricultural runoff is generally to poor water quality, which is not conducive to the secondary utilization of water resources. The pollutants emitted will also seriously affect the water quality of the receiving water body, forming a functional water shortage.

Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) Water pollution eventually leads to serious health issues and water shortage
- (B) The FAO states that almost 50% of irrigation water after it mixes with rivers, can lead to water hazards



- (C) One of the critical factors that leads to immense damage to rivers is the farmland tailwater
- (D) It is important to understand the control of pollution sources in the limited concept of river management that exists today.
- (E) None of the above

Q20 Misconceptions feeding the idea of the empty atom can be dismantled by carefully interpreting quantum theory, which describes the physics of molecules, atoms and subatomic particles. According to quantum theory, the building blocks of matter – like electrons, nuclei and the molecules they form – can be portrayed either as waves or particles. Leave them to evolve by themselves without human interference, and they act like delocalised waves in the shape of continuous clouds.

Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the findings that quantum theory describes the physics of molecules by portraying them as both waves and particles?

- (A) The concept of delocalised waves aligns with experimental observations of the behavior of electrons, nuclei, and molecules.
- (B) Alternative scientific theories have gained widespread acceptance among physicists studying the structure of atoms.
- (C) Quantum theory highlights human interference as the primary factor determining whether particles and waves are delocalized or exhibit specific shapes.
- (D) The historical development of quantum theory was largely unaffected by experimental evidence.
- (E) Experimental evidence shows that particles behave as waves when external energy is applied.

Q21 In recent years, the urbanization process has been accelerated, leading to the change of urban sub-bedding types, such as a large number of natural sub-bedding surfaces such as vegetation,

woodland, and grassland cultivated land are gradually developed into impervious sub-bedding surfaces such as roofs, roads, and squares. This further triggers the reduction of rainwater infiltration and the acceleration of flow production and confluence, which greatly increases surface runoff and makes it easy for water to accumulate in the rainy season. At the same time, the enhanced surface runoff leads to a much higher concentration of pollutants in the stormwater, which reduces the quality of the receiving water body and increases pollution, greatly affecting the urban water environment.

Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) An increased runoff means more pollutants which eventually leads to a more toxic urban water environment
- (B) An accelerated flow leads to an increased runoff which makes it very difficult for water to gather during the rains
- (C) There has been a massive transformation in the urban sub-bedding categories owing to the increasing rate of urbanization
- (D) Lately, urbanization has led to the evolution of rainproof sub-beds in place of natural sub-beds.
- (E) Urbanization has accelerated the transformation of natural sub-bedding surfaces into impervious surfaces, leading to increased surface runoff and pollution in stormwater

Q22 A study by Ahankara et al. highlighted the alarming statistics of gender inequalities in Sub-Saharan Africa and discussed various strategies to mitigate them and improve services for women and girls. To overcome household, educational, work/employment, and housing inequities, the authors emphasized that these interconnected disparities require broader policy actions to improve the current burden faced by many women. The review concludes to avoid/discourage attending mass gatherings and



ensure face-masking with non-medical cloth-like masks, which are low-cost preventive measures to prevent the virus's spread among women.

Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) Another study from northeast India by Padhye addressed the challenges of accessing maternal health care amid the COVID-19 pandemic.
- (B) The study based on women can only be conducted face-to-face because of which the results are disparate and inconsistent.
- (C) The study found that women were spending out-of-pocket for some essential services despite accessing public health facilities.
- (D) They further concluded that the major challenges, such as lack of transport facilities and medicines, resulted in a high proportion of Caesarian section deliveries and stillbirths.
- (E) Implementing broader policy actions to address gender inequalities in Sub-Saharan Africa can contribute to improving women's access to essential services, including healthcare, education, employment, and housing, thereby reducing the burden faced by many women.

Q23 The word "Conference" comes from "confer" meaning to compare views or to counsel. A conference means a meeting involving two or more experts to discuss or exchange opinions or new information about a particular topic in any particular field. This meeting allows the exchange of ideas across generations and the globe. In effect, this meeting is a medium for teaching and hence needs to be assessed from time to time to evaluate its effectiveness in achieving its goal. Delegates attending such conferences enroll themselves, expecting to learn new techniques with more finesse in return for their effort and time away from work, family, and expenses. They believe that their knowledge will be enhanced and eye the meeting to inspire them with new ideas and research related to their field.

Organizers of conferences need to respect these different investments of the delegates while planning such events. Over the last few decades, due to the possibility and ease of travel across the globe and advances in audio-visual broadcasting, there is no dearth of achieving this, but the main question is whether we can achieve the objective of holding such events.

Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) Different meetings may have diverse needs and ideas; hence, it is critical to plan events according to the preferences of the delegates
- (B) Delegates joining conferences sacrifice their time to learn something from the outcomes of the event.
- (C) Undoubtedly the events, meetings, and conferences are taking place across the globe; however, it can be ascertained through research that the primary goal is not met
- (D) A conference is a meeting that allows people to collaborate, interact, and engage.
- (E) None of the above

Q24 Sleep keeps us healthy and positively affects our quality of life. In a society where shift work is common, the sleeping patterns of those working shifts are often disrupted. To understand the correlation between different shift patterns, sociodemographic factors, and sleep disorders, a team of researchers has now examined sleep in more than 37,000 shift workers. They found that more than half of the people working regular night shifts had at least one sleep disorder, such as insomnia, sleep apnea, or restless leg syndrome. Sleep is critical for daytime and neurocognitive functioning, as well as physical and mental health. When people work shifts – in 2015, 21% of workers in the European Union did – their circadian sleep-wake rhythms are commonly disrupted. Now, researchers in the Netherlands have investigated the relationship between different shift working patterns, sociodemographic factors, and sleep disorders.



Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) It has been observed that more than 50 percent of people working night shifts were suffering from one of the critical sleep disorders
- (B) The study found that shift workers experience no significant impact on their sleep patterns compared to non-shift workers.
- (C) Research has also identified that people who work in different shifts have a relationship between sociodemographic and sleep issues.
- (D) Sleep disorders can lead to multiple chronic diseases like depression, anxiety, virus attacks, etc.
- (E) It has been observed that almost 50 percent of people working night shifts in the European Union have been diagnosed with disturbed sleep-wake rhythms

- Q25** The world's oceans absorb approximately a quarter of all carbon dioxide (CO₂) emissions. During absorption, CO₂ reacts with seawater and oceanic pH levels fall. This is known as ocean acidification and results in lower carbon ion concentrations. Certain ocean inhabitants use carbon ions to build and sustain their shells. Pteropods, which are important components of the marine ecosystem, are among them. Certain aspects of pteropods, including life cycles and population dynamics, are not well-studied. This is partly due to their size – some sea butterfly species measure less than a millimeter – and poor long-term survival in captivity. Now, a team of marine scientists has examined the life cycles, abundance, and seasonal variability of shelled sea butterflies in the north-east Scotia Sea, a region undergoing some of the fastest climate change in the Southern Ocean.

Identify the appropriate weakening statement that opposes the author in the given paragraph

- (A) Because of the fast rate of climate change and owing to their small size, sea butterfly species have been researched.

- (B) When carbon dioxide emissions react with seawater the PH falls and reduces carbon ion concentrations
- (C) Ocean acidification takes place when oceanic pH levels are mitigated.
- (D) Pteropods, although have not been elaborately studied, it is clear that they need carbon ions to survive.
- (E) Pteropods are well-studied, and their life cycles and population dynamics are fully understood.

- Q26** A recent study suggests that employees who frequently take short breaks throughout the workday are more productive than those who work for long, uninterrupted periods. Traditionally, workplace productivity models have emphasized prolonged focus as key to efficiency. However, researchers now argue that frequent breaks improve cognitive performance by preventing mental fatigue. A competing view, however, proposes that the increased productivity may not result from the breaks themselves but rather from differences in employees' time management skills—individuals who plan and structure their breaks effectively may simply be better at organizing their overall workload, leading to higher efficiency. Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the competing view that time management skills, rather than breaks themselves, are responsible for the observed productivity boost?

- (A) Employees who take frequent breaks report feeling less mentally fatigued than those who work continuously, regardless of their productivity levels.
- (B) A study finds that employees who are naturally better at managing time tend to take breaks at optimal moments and return to work more focused, while those with poor time management often take breaks inefficiently.
- (C)



Workers in highly structured jobs, where break times are predetermined and mandatory, do not show the same productivity gains as those who can choose when to take breaks.

- (D) Employees in companies that encourage frequent breaks show a higher overall job satisfaction rate, even when their productivity levels remain unchanged.
- (E) Brain scan research shows that taking breaks activates neural pathways associated with relaxation and problem-solving, which may contribute to improved performance.

Q27 Many urban planners argue that expanding public transportation networks reduces traffic congestion by encouraging people to rely on buses and trains instead of personal vehicles. However, a recent study challenges this assumption, suggesting that the decline in congestion may not be due to improved public transit but rather to rising fuel costs, which deter car usage. The study found that in cities where public transportation expanded but fuel prices remained stable, traffic congestion showed little to no reduction. This raises the possibility that financial constraints, rather than improved transit accessibility, are the primary reason for decreased traffic congestion.

Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the argument that rising fuel costs, rather than public transit expansion, are responsible for reducing traffic congestion?

- (A) In some cities where fuel prices increased but no major improvements were made to public transit, traffic congestion still declined significantly.
- (B) Surveys indicate that a majority of commuters who switched to public transportation cited convenience and reliability rather than financial concerns as their main reason for doing so.
- (C) Cities that introduced free or heavily subsidized public transit programs saw a

significant shift in commuter behavior, with more people opting for buses and trains over personal vehicles.

- (D) Data from multiple cities show that traffic congestion tends to decrease immediately after sharp increases in fuel prices, even when no new public transportation infrastructure is introduced.
- (E) In cities where public transportation expansion led to improved service efficiency and shorter travel times, there was a noticeable decline in personal vehicle use

Q28 A recent study claims that remote work significantly improves employee productivity because it eliminates commuting time and allows workers to operate in a comfortable, personalized environment. The study suggests that without the distractions of a traditional office, employees are able to focus more effectively, leading to higher efficiency and output. Based on this, many companies are considering long-term remote work policies as a means to enhance overall productivity. Which of the following, if true, would most weaken the argument that remote work significantly improves employee productivity?

- (A) Employees working remotely report spending an average of 20% of their workday on non-work-related tasks, such as household chores and personal errands
- (B) Companies that adopted fully remote work models saw an initial increase in productivity, but after a year, many employees reported feeling disconnected and struggled with collaboration.
- (C) A survey found that employees who had the option to work remotely or in the office performed equally well, regardless of their chosen work environment
- (D) Some employees working remotely reported higher job satisfaction, even when their productivity levels remained unchanged.
- (E)



Firms that implemented hybrid work models—combining remote and in-office work—showed a greater productivity increase than those that switched to fully remote work.

- Q29** A recent economic report asserts that raising the minimum wage leads to overall economic growth because higher wages increase consumer spending. The report claims that when low-income workers receive higher pay, they spend more on goods and services, thereby stimulating businesses and creating a positive cycle of economic expansion. Based on this, the report concludes that increasing the minimum wage is a reliable strategy for fostering sustained economic growth.

Which of the following, if true, would most

weaken the argument that raising the minimum wage leads to sustained economic growth?

- (A) In some regions where the minimum wage was increased, businesses reduced hiring and relied more on automation, leading to a decline in job availability.
- (B) Higher wages can lead to increased consumer spending, but this effect is often temporary, as inflation adjusts prices to compensate for rising labor costs.
- (C) A study found that businesses in sectors with low profit margins responded to higher wages by passing increased costs onto consumers, reducing overall demand for their goods and services.
- (D) Countries that have maintained a relatively low minimum wage for decades, such as certain developing nations, have experienced strong economic growth driven by investment and trade rather than wage increases.
- (E) Many workers who received wage increases reported improved financial stability but did not significantly alter their spending habits,

choosing instead to save more of their earnings.

- Q30** A recent study suggests that businesses implementing a four-day workweek experience increased employee productivity and overall profitability. The study claims that a shorter workweek reduces employee burnout, improves focus, and enhances job satisfaction, leading to more efficient work. As a result, companies that transition to a four-day workweek can expect long-term financial benefits and a competitive edge in attracting top talent.
- Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the argument that a four-day workweek leads to increased productivity and profitability?
- (A) Several large companies that adopted a four-day workweek reported an increase in revenue per employee while maintaining or even improving customer satisfaction levels.
 - (B) A survey found that employees working a four-day schedule reported higher job satisfaction, but their overall output per week remained similar to that of a five-day schedule.
 - (C) Studies show that employees in organizations with flexible work schedules, including four-day workweeks, are more likely to stay with their employers long-term, reducing hiring and training costs.
 - (D) Some industries, particularly in the technology and creative sectors, have seen improvements in innovation and project completion rates after shifting to a four-day workweek.
 - (E) In countries where shorter workweeks are common, national productivity levels per hour worked tend to be higher than in countries with longer workweeks.



Answer Key

Q1 (D)
Q2 (C)
Q3 (B)
Q4 (A)
Q5 (E)
Q6 (B)
Q7 (E)
Q8 (A)
Q9 (D)
Q10 (A)
Q11 (A)
Q12 (A)
Q13 (A)
Q14 (B)
Q15 (A)

Q16 (E)
Q17 (B)
Q18 (E)
Q19 (D)
Q20 (A)
Q21 (B)
Q22 (B)
Q23 (C)
Q24 (E)
Q25 (A)
Q26 (B)
Q27 (D)
Q28 (B)
Q29 (B)
Q30 (A)



Hints & Solutions

Note: scan the QR code to watch video solution

Q1 Text Solution:

The Essence of the Question – A strengthening statement is a supporting statement, in the form of an example, analogy, a similar situation, or a deduced statement from within the passage, that promotes or encourages the author's statement.

You must find the best option that strengthens or supports the author, as given in the statement!

Correct Answer – D – This option is correct.

Option D is the best strengthening statement, because if certain parameters and conditions are looked into, then the significant levels of indoor pollution can be reduced and would stop having an impact on the health of the inhabitants

Incorrect Options:

Option A does not support the main statement, instead, it highlights another topic of discussion of transport which is not the crux of the situation.

Option B is conclusive and can be retrieved from the main statement. It is evident that significant levels of indoor pollution make dwellings unsafe, which has an impact on the health of the inhabitants

Option C is a sheer contradiction and cannot be termed as a strengthening statement. It favors housing as safe dwellings.

Option E directly contradicts the main idea presented in the passage, which emphasizes the direct influence of indoor residential environments on human health. The option dismisses the significance of indoor pollution and denies the evidence of associations with various health issues mentioned in the passage.

Q2 Text Solution:

Essence and Hint of the Question

This question evaluates your ability to identify a statement that weakens the author's claim about the disruptive impact of AI on the global labor market. The correct answer should directly challenge the claim that AI adoption will

significantly disrupt employment, particularly by focusing on factors that limit AI's widespread implementation.

Correct Option: C

Explanation: Option C weakens the author's argument by stating that the adoption of AI technologies remains slow due to high costs and limited infrastructure, challenging the prediction of widespread disruption to the labor market. If AI adoption is slower than anticipated, its impact on jobs and economies will also be delayed, undermining the claim that 50% of jobs will be replaced within two decades.

The passage assumes rapid adoption of AI-driven automation but does not address the constraints posed by high costs or limited infrastructure, making Option C a direct counterpoint.

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect:

Option A: This supports, rather than weakens, the author's claim by reinforcing the idea that AI can replace human jobs in routine sectors like manufacturing and logistics.

"Sectors such as manufacturing, transportation, and customer service [are] particularly vulnerable to job losses due to... AI-driven automation."

Option B: While this highlights a challenge (affordability of upskilling), it does not weaken the central claim about AI replacing jobs. Instead, it aligns with the author's argument that workforce training is essential to prepare for an AI-driven economy.

"Many countries and organizations need to heavily invest in workforce upskilling and reskilling programs."

Option D: This supports the author's argument by providing another example of AI replacing traditional labor, rather than challenging the claim.



The author predicts job losses across multiple sectors due to AI adoption, and this example confirms the trend.

Option E: This option reinforces the author's claim by emphasizing the widespread adoption of AI and its impact on employment. It does not introduce any counterpoints to the author's argument.

The passage predicts that "50% of existing jobs could be replaced by automation and AI technologies."

Q3 Text Solution:

Essence and Hint of the Question

This question requires you to identify the conclusion that best aligns with the evidence presented in the study regarding the impact of remote work on productivity. The correct answer should reflect the study's findings on how remote work, when supported by effective policies, leads to higher productivity.

Correct Option: B

Explanation: Option B is correct because it aligns directly with the study's findings that effective remote work policies—such as clear communication protocols and virtual team-building activities—help mitigate challenges and lead to higher productivity. The study also highlights the benefits of remote work, including fewer workplace distractions and better work-life balance, which improve employee output.

"Employees working remotely reported higher levels of productivity due to fewer workplace distractions."

"Organizations that implemented robust remote work policies... reported a net gain in productivity metrics compared to pre-remote work levels."

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect:

Option A: While this statement addresses a potential challenge of remote work (isolation), the study focuses on productivity benefits from remote work and how effective policies mitigate challenges. The study does not highlight isolation

or ethics as a central theme. The passage emphasizes "fewer workplace distractions" and "improved work-life balance," not struggles with isolation.

Option C: The study does not discuss issues related to monitoring tools as a significant barrier to productivity. Instead, it highlights the role of workplace distractions and flexible schedules in boosting productivity, making this option irrelevant. No mention of monitoring tools or related challenges appears in the passage.

Option D: This option focuses on teamwork and collaboration in specific industries rather than the broader productivity benefits of remote work discussed in the study. While opponents of remote work argue this, the study emphasizes the net gain in productivity metrics when remote work is supported by effective policies.

"Opponents of remote work argue... better team dynamics," but the study concludes with improved productivity through effective policies.

Option E: The study does not attribute the transition to remote work to cost-cutting measures. Instead, it focuses on productivity improvements and work-life balance as the primary benefits. This option introduces a claim not supported by the passage. Cost-cutting is not mentioned in the study.

Q4 Text Solution:

Explanation of Answer Choices:

A) Correct Answer: This strengthens the argument because it provides an additional reason why handwriting improves memory retention—students who write notes by hand tend to revisit them more often, reinforcing their learning.

B) Incorrect: This highlights a reason why students might prefer typing but does not explain why handwriting leads to better retention.

C) Incorrect: While this statement is true for some subjects, it does not directly support the



claim that handwriting improves memory retention.

D) Incorrect: This suggests a downside of using laptops but does not directly prove that handwriting enhances memory retention.

E) Incorrect: This weakens the argument by suggesting that typing can be just as effective as handwriting for memory retention.

Q5 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: E) *Participants who engaged in non-physical activities, such as reading or meditating in green spaces, reported similar mood improvements.*

Explanation:

- **A)** Adds a comparison with non-urban natural settings, which is tangential to the claim about urban green spaces.
- **B)** While comparing green spaces to indoor facilities is useful, it does not isolate green spaces as the critical factor.
- **C)** Addresses external factors, which is helpful but not directly tied to the passage's argument.
- **D)** Supports the idea that green spaces reduce stress but does not distinguish between physical activity and the environment.
- **E)** Strengthens the claim by isolating the effect of green spaces from physical activity.

Q6 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: B) *Regions implementing UBI have shown no significant changes in unemployment rates compared to those without it.*

Explanation:

- **A)** Suggests that UBI fosters education and skill development, which counters the argument against UBI.
- **B)** Weakens the argument by demonstrating that UBI does not discourage work.
- **C)** Talks about administrative costs, which is irrelevant to the criticism of reduced productivity.

- **D)** Focuses on life satisfaction, which is unrelated to productivity.
- **E)** Suggests entrepreneurial ventures, which weakens the criticism but less directly than B.

Q7 Text Solution:

Brief Essence and Hint of the Question:

The question asks you to identify which statement strengthens the conclusion that private businesses are playing an expanding and essential role in water management, as described in the passage. Find the option that correctly emphasizes the role of private businesses in bringing new technologies and financing to address the global freshwater crisis, directly aligning with the passage.

Correct Answer: Option E

This statement strengthens the conclusion from the passage because the passage discusses how private businesses are playing an expanding role in water management. It specifically mentions that, given the global freshwater crisis, private businesses are bringing new approaches and new challenges to a traditionally government-dominated field. Option A highlights the importance of new technologies and financing, which aligns with the passage's argument that private businesses have become essential in addressing the freshwater crisis. This focus on their expertise and growing involvement directly supports the conclusion that private businesses are becoming crucial players in water management.

The passage states: "Private businesses and markets are playing a rapidly expanding role, bringing both new approaches and new challenges to a historically public field." This confirms that private businesses are becoming essential due to their expertise in innovation and financing, making Option A the correct answer.

Why the Other Options are Incorrect:

Option A exaggerates the conclusion of the passage because it emphasizes the role of private businesses in water management as



collaborative. The passage emphasizes that while private businesses are playing an "expanding role" in water management today, they are still largely supporting players, particularly in areas like "new technologies, institutions, and financing." Therefore, this option does not support the role of private businesses in water management.

Option B downplays the role of private businesses by suggesting that their contributions are mainly technical support, which contradicts the passage's argument about their expanding role. The passage emphasizes that private businesses are bringing new approaches and are becoming more central to water management, not just providing technical assistance. Therefore, Option B weakens the significance of private businesses, making it an incorrect answer.

Option C is incorrect because it exaggerates the role of private businesses, claiming they have taken over governments and now dominate water management. The passage explicitly states that private businesses are expanding their role but does not suggest that they have taken over from governments. The role of private businesses is still complementary and expanding, but not dominant in the way Option C suggests.

Option D misrepresents the conclusion by stating that it is the responsibility of private businesses to ensure a clean and affordable water supply.

The passage does not suggest that private businesses are responsible for the water supply, but rather that they are playing an expanding role due to the need for innovation.

Governments are still responsible for water administration, and the private sector's role is supportive and expanding, not one of full responsibility.

Q8 Text Solution:

Explanation of Answer Choices:

A) Correct Answer: This directly strengthens the conclusion by providing additional evidence that short breaks lead to better task performance,

supporting the claim that they improve productivity.

B) Incorrect: This weakens the argument by suggesting that some employees can be productive without breaks, making the effect of the policy less clear.

C) Incorrect: If other companies did not see the same results, it weakens the general applicability of the conclusion.

D) Incorrect: This suggests a potential downside (less overall work time), which could weaken the argument rather than strengthen it.

E) Incorrect: If only volunteers participated, it introduces bias, making the survey results less reliable, which weakens the argument.

Q9 Text Solution:

Correct Answer:

D. Several prominent thought leaders have criticized the term for lacking precision, often likening it to vague generalizations.

Explanation of Options:

- **A.** This weakens the premise because it argues for the term's usefulness, emphasizing its versatility rather than its redundancy or ambiguity.
- **B.** This strengthens the premise by highlighting the term's inconsistent usage, making it a potential source of confusion. However, it is weaker compared to **D**, which directly supports the skepticism by referencing specific criticisms.
- **C.** This weakens the premise as it demonstrates public confidence in understanding the term, contrary to claims of its redundancy.
- **D.** This is the strongest option as it explicitly addresses the skepticism by citing critiques about the term's lack of precision, aligning closely with the passage's focus on its perceived redundancy and vagueness.
- **E.** This weakens the premise by suggesting that the term is well-defined and structured,



countering the argument that it is confusing or redundant.

Video Solution:



Q10 Text Solution:

Essence of the Question: This is an argument-strengthening question that asks you to identify the option that would provide evidence to support the idea given in the question based on the provided paragraph

Correct Answer: A

The paragraph discusses how peer support works by drawing upon the innate human potential to connect, listen, and offer empathy, which helps in recognizing and validating emotional pain. The goal is to identify an option that reinforces the assumption that peer support uses this human instinct to recognize and validate emotional distress.

Option Analysis:

- **A. Individuals experiencing peer support report higher levels of emotional recognition.**
 - **Correct.** This option directly strengthens the assumption, as it suggests that peer support leads to increased emotional recognition, validating the idea that this connection helps individuals recognize and affirm each other's emotional pain.
- **B. The basic human instinct to connect is limited to verbal communication specifically.**
 - **Incorrect.** While it suggests that human connection is limited to verbal communication, the paragraph emphasizes that peer support is based on an instinct to connect in a broader sense, including non-

verbal communication, empathy, and recognition. Limiting it to verbal communication would undermine the broader scope of this instinct.

- **C. Peer support involves providing solutions and advice rather than just empathy and respect.**
 - **Incorrect.** The paragraph emphasizes the importance of empathy and respect, not problem-solving. If peer support involves primarily offering solutions, it would diverge from the assumption that recognizing and validating emotional pain is key.
- **D. The emotional distress faced by individuals is exclusively dependent on external factors and not by interpersonal relationships.**
 - **Incorrect.** This option contradicts the idea that interpersonal relationships (such as peer support) are crucial in providing emotional recognition. If distress were only caused by external factors, it would weaken the premise that peer support validates emotional pain through human connection.
- **E. Peer support has been shown to foster resilience through non-verbal cues and body language recognition.**
 - **Close but incorrect.** This option is close but not directly relevant. While it mentions non-verbal cues, it shifts the focus toward resilience rather than emotional recognition. The paragraph emphasizes the importance of recognition and validation of emotional pain, not resilience through body language.

Q11 Text Solution:

Explanation of Answer Choices:

A) Correct Answer: This strengthens the argument by confirming that the electricity powering the buses is clean. If the electricity



came from polluting sources like coal, the reduction in air pollution might not be as significant.

B) Incorrect: The cost of the buses is unrelated to whether they reduce pollution. This does not strengthen the claim about environmental benefits.

C) Incorrect: An increase in ridership does not directly prove that electric buses reduce air pollution.

D) Incorrect: This weakens the argument by suggesting that diesel buses can also be improved to lower emissions, making the switch to electric less necessary.

E) Incorrect: This weakens the argument by highlighting a potential disadvantage of electric buses rather than supporting their environmental benefits.

Q12 Text Solution:

Essence of the Question: This is an argument-strengthening question that asks you to identify the option that would provide evidence to support the idea given in the question based on the provided paragraph

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: This choice strengthens the argument by providing historical evidence that political leaders deliberately downplayed the consequences of nuclear conflict that supports the idea that Anders deplored their collective blindness in instrumentalizing the threat of mutual destruction for political gain.

Incorrect Answers:

B) It does not directly contribute to strengthening the argument regarding Anders' deplored collective blindness and the instrumentalization of the threat of mutual destruction.

C) This option is incorrect as it doesn't provide any evidence stating the argument focuses on the collective blindness of tacticians and politicians during the nuclear age.

D) This option does not directly contribute to the argument concerning the deplored blindness in instrumentalizing the threat of mutual destruction for political purposes.

E) This contradicts the passage, which states that peace became "the perpetual preparation for war." This implies that military efforts and arms buildup continued rather than decreased

Trap of the Question: Strengthening questions can trap you while creating distractions in the options. The options may include partially relevant information, contrasting options, facts beyond the paragraph and choices that are too narrowed or alien. This is to challenge the aspirant's judgment and evaluate their critical reasoning skills.

Q13 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: A) *Independent studies confirm that AI-assisted diagnostics result in fewer false negatives and false positives compared to traditional methods.*

Explanation:

- A) Directly strengthens the claim about improved accuracy of AI in diagnostics.
- B) Talks about AI learning capabilities, which supports its potential but not its current efficacy.
- C) Focuses on cost savings, which is relevant but secondary to the argument on diagnostic accuracy.
- D) Highlights consistency but does not directly address the improvement in accuracy.
- E) Discusses earlier detection, which is a benefit but not the primary claim in the passage.

Q14 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

To weaken the argument, the statement must challenge or highlight limitations regarding the availability and widespread use of 3D shapes as described in the paragraph. Option B points out



the challenges of building and benchmarking 3D shape datasets, emphasizing that it is a time-consuming and expensive process. This contradicts the author's assertion that 3D shapes are "largely available nowadays" and easily shared, thus weakening the argument. Other options fail to weaken the argument:

- **A** discusses the growth of computational devices, which is unrelated to the challenges of 3D shape accessibility.
- **C** and **D** focus on advancements in deep learning, which complement rather than oppose the argument.
- **E** reinforces the benefits and accessibility of 3D data, directly supporting the author's claims instead of opposing them.

Q15 Text Solution:

The Essence of the Question – The question asks you to identify the option that weakens a given fact or conclusion given in the statement. The weakening statement is a contradicting statement, that does not support the argument but contradicts it.

Correct Answer – A – This option is correct.

Option A is the right answer as it weakens the intent of the author. Here a matter of concern is discussed which has no solution; thus it is a weakening statement.

Incorrect Options:

Option B is not a contradictory statement, but a broad option, that is too broad to be considered as the right answer. Here, the option focuses on finding substitutes for conventional natural aggregates

Option C highlights the achievements of green constructionism and how it helps to limit risks to human health, thus, it is a supporting statement and not a weakening statement

Option D is not a weakening statement as it abides by the content in the main statement which says that the supply and scarcity of sand and gravel at reasonable rates are currently a concern for the construction sector.

Option E aligns with the author's assertion that the construction sector is facing challenges related to the supply of natural aggregates and is actively seeking solutions.

Q16 Text Solution:

Explanation of Answer Choices:

E) Correct Answer: This weakens the argument because athletes generally have a lower risk of heart disease due to their active lifestyle, healthy diets, and overall fitness levels. If the study participants were mainly athletes, their reduced heart disease risk might not be due to green tea but rather their naturally healthier lifestyles. This suggests that the study's results may not apply to the general population, weakening the claim that green tea itself is responsible for reducing heart disease risk.

A) Incorrect: The presence of allergies does not challenge the overall claim that green tea helps reduce heart disease risk.

B) Incorrect: While caffeine affects heart rate, this does not directly disprove the claim that green tea reduces heart disease risk.

C) Incorrect: A small sample size might limit the study's strength, but it does not necessarily disprove the claim about green tea's benefits.

D) Incorrect: The reason people drink green tea (e.g., for relaxation) does not weaken the claim about its effects on heart disease.

Q17 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: (B) The energy required to produce alternative packaging materials may exceed the environmental costs of plastic packaging.

Explanation:

- The claim assumes that reducing plastic packaging is an unequivocal environmental benefit.
- (A) is irrelevant: Discounts and purchasing habits do not directly relate to the environmental impact.



- (C) is incorrect: Recycling habits are not discussed as a major variable in the argument.
- (D) partially weakens but does not address the environmental cost of production.
- (E) introduces a new concern (food waste) but does not directly weaken the original claim about plastic waste.
- (B) is the strongest weakening argument because it shows that alternative packaging might offset or even worsen the environmental impact, directly challenging the claim.

Video Solution:**Q18 Text Solution:**

Correct Answer – E – This option is correct.

Option E is the best supporting statement that revolves around improving the approaches to determining the priority directions for the development of state financial control

Incorrect Options:

Option A weakens the intention of the author. If the conditions of social transformation are questioned, it implies doubt about its practicality and feasibility.

Option B has a negative tone and opposes the viewpoint of the author as it claims that the functioning of state financial control as a component of the state finance management system has been demerited

Option C is too broad and instead of strengthening the argument, it takes it to another unrelated topic. Here the core idea is related to the state finance system and its policies, however, this option considers reliability of nationwide policies

Option D is incorrect because it contradicts the main idea presented in the paragraph.

Q19 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

The author emphasizes the diversification of river management, with a focus on addressing pollution sources and agricultural non-point source pollution. A weakening statement would challenge this idea by undermining the effectiveness or scope of the proposed solutions.

- **Option D** weakens the argument by suggesting that current river management concepts are "limited," implying that the approach highlighted by the author is insufficient or constrained, which opposes the claim of diversified and effective solutions.

Why the other options are incorrect:

- **A:** This supports the author's argument by emphasizing the adverse effects of water pollution, reinforcing the need for solutions.
- **B:** This aligns with the author's point regarding the FAO's findings on irrigation water and agricultural runoff contributing to water hazards, supporting the argument rather than weakening it.
- **C:** This reiterates the author's claim about farmland tailwater being a critical factor in river pollution, reinforcing rather than opposing the argument.
- **E:** This is not the correct answer, as Option D explicitly weakens the argument.

Thus, **Option D** is the appropriate weakening statement.

Q20 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: This option strengthens the assumption by connecting the concept of delocalised waves with experimental observations and measurements.

Incorrect Answers:

B) This choice weakens the assumption by introducing the idea that alternative scientific theories have gained widespread acceptance.



C) This choice misinterprets the paragraph's emphasis on leaving particles to evolve without human interference, suggesting the opposite and weakening the assumption.

D) This option states doubt about the historical development of quantum theory, weakening the assumption.

E) Incorrect (Close but Wrong). While this relates to particle-wave behavior, it specifies that waves emerge when external energy is applied. This limits the scope of the passage, which states that particles evolve into delocalised waves naturally, without external interference.

Q21 Text Solution:

The Essence of the Question – The question asks you to identify the option that weakens a given fact or conclusion given in the statement. The weakening statement is a contradicting statement, that does not support the argument but contradicts it.

Correct Answer – B – This option is correct.

Option B is a weakening statement and it is evident from the fact that the reduction of rainwater infiltration and the acceleration of flow production and confluence, greatly increases surface runoff and makes it easy for water to accumulate in the rainy season.

Incorrect Options:

Option A strengthens the passage wherein the author claims that the enhanced surface runoff leads to a much higher concentration of pollutants in the stormwater, which reduces the quality of the receiving water body and increases pollution, greatly affecting the urban water environment.

Option C is a supporting statement as it is evident that in recent years, the urbanization process has been accelerated, leading to the change of urban sub-bedding types, Option D strengthens the author's intention as it has been claimed that a large number of natural sub-bedding surfaces such as vegetation, woodland, and grassland cultivated land are

gradually developed into impervious sub-bedding surfaces such as roofs, roads, and squares.

Option E is also a strengthening statement

Q22 Text Solution:

The Essence of the Question – The question asks you to identify the option that weakens a given fact or conclusion given in the statement. The weakening statement is a contradicting statement, that does not support the argument but contradicts it.

Correct Answer – B – This option is correct.

Option B weakens the author's intention as the data is not enough to conduct a thorough research; thus any outcome of such low criteria cannot be relied upon as a representation of the entire group.

Incorrect Options:

Option A supports the main statement, as this research is conducted for the overall welfare and well-being of women just like other research topics that the author mentions in the main statement.

Option C supports the main topic of gender inequalities, showcasing that despite the launch of various strategies to promote gender equality, women still have to pay for their healthcare bills.

Option D clarifies the lack of infrastructural facilities and amenities which have led to the poor condition of women.

E option supports the passage by reinforcing the importance of broader policy actions in addressing gender inequalities in Sub-Saharan Africa.

Q23 Text Solution:

The Essence of the Question – The question asks you to identify the option that weakens a given fact or conclusion given in the statement. The weakening statement is a contradicting statement, that does not support the argument but contradicts it.

Correct Answer – C – This option is correct.



Option C is the weakening statement, as the same has been questioned in the conclusive idea of the main statement. However, it can be confirmed that if the primary objective is not achieved then the central theme of the main statement is weakened or questioned.

Incorrect Options:

Option A is not the answer, as it strengthens the main argument, instead of weakening it. According to the author knowledge will get enhanced and eye the meeting to inspire them with new ideas and research related to their field. Organizers of conferences need to respect these different investments of the delegates while planning such events

Option B is a verifiable fact that can be concluded from the fact that delegates attending such conferences enroll themselves, expecting to learn new techniques with more finesse in return for their effort and time away from work, family, and expenses

Option D cannot be the right answer as a meeting allows the exchange of ideas across generations and the globe and is a medium for teaching and hence needs to be assessed from time to time to evaluate its effectiveness in achieving its goal.

Q24 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

The paragraph emphasizes the negative impact of shift work on sleep, particularly night shifts, leading to various sleep disorders. **Option B** weakens the argument because it introduces a fact that suggests a smaller percentage (almost 50%) of night shift workers in the European Union suffer from disturbed sleep-wake rhythms, which reduces the overall impact of the claim made by the author that more than half of the people working regular night shifts have sleep disorders.

Why the other options are incorrect:

- **A:** This option does not weaken the argument. It supports the claim that a significant portion of night shift workers suffer from sleep disorders, which aligns with the author's position.
- **B** This option directly contradicts the information presented in the paragraph but it does not logically weaken the paragraph.
- **C:** This statement also supports the author's point by mentioning the relationship between shift work, sociodemographic factors, and sleep issues, which strengthens the argument.
- **D:** While this statement adds additional information about the consequences of sleep disorders, it does not directly oppose the author's claim about shift work and sleep disorders. It focuses on the broader impact of sleep disorders but does not challenge the link between shift work and sleep issues.

Thus, **Option E** is the appropriate weakening statement.

Q25 Text Solution:

The Essence of the Question – The question asks you to identify the option that weakens a given fact or conclusion given in the statement. The weakening statement is a contradicting statement, that does not support the argument but contradicts it.

Correct Answer – A – This option is correct.

Option A is the weakening statement as the main statement clarifies how partly due to their size – some sea butterfly species had poor long-term survival in captivity; however, a team of marine scientists has examined life cycles, abundance, and seasonal variability of shelled sea butterflies in the north-east Scotia Sea, a region undergoing some of the fastest climate change in the Southern Ocean.

Incorrect Options:

Option B can be verified from the statement that the world's oceans absorb approximately a quarter of all carbon dioxide (CO₂) emissions. During absorption, CO₂ reacts with seawater and



oceanic pH levels fall. This is known as ocean acidification and results in lower carbon ion concentrations.

Option C is a supporting statement that can be verified from the statement that the world's oceans absorb approximately a quarter of all carbon dioxide (CO₂) emissions. During absorption, CO₂ reacts with seawater and oceanic pH levels fall. This is known as ocean acidification and results in lower carbon ion concentrations.

Option D can be verified from the fact that certain ocean inhabitants use carbon ions to build and sustain their shells. Pteropods, which are important components of the marine ecosystem, are among them.

Option E contradicts the paragraph explicitly states that certain aspects of pteropods, including their life cycles and population dynamics, are *not well-studied* therefore this option neither strengthens nor weakens logically

Q26 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: B

B. A study finds that employees who are naturally better at managing time tend to take breaks at optimal moments and return to work more focused, while those with poor time management often take breaks inefficiently. This directly supports the competing view that time management skills, rather than the act of taking breaks itself, explain the observed productivity boost. It implies that better organization—not just taking breaks—leads to improved efficiency.

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect

A. Employees who take frequent breaks report feeling less mentally fatigued than those who work continuously, regardless of their productivity levels.

This supports the idea that breaks help reduce fatigue, but it does not link productivity to time management skills, which is the key claim being strengthened.

C. Workers in highly structured jobs, where break times are predetermined and mandatory, do not show the same productivity gains as those who can choose when to take breaks.

This suggests that break timing matters, but it doesn't establish that time management skills are the reason for the productivity boost. The lower productivity in structured jobs could be due to inflexible scheduling rather than a lack of time management skills.

D. Employees in companies that encourage frequent breaks show a higher overall job satisfaction rate, even when their productivity levels remain unchanged.

This focuses on job satisfaction, not productivity, and does not support the idea that time management skills drive efficiency.

E. Brain scan research shows that taking breaks activates neural pathways associated with relaxation and problem-solving, which may contribute to improved performance.

This supports the idea that breaks themselves improve cognitive function, which weakens the competing view that time management, not breaks, is responsible for productivity gains.

It best supports the argument that better time management—not breaks themselves—is responsible for increased productivity

Q27 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: D

D. Data from multiple cities show that traffic congestion tends to decrease immediately after sharp increases in fuel prices, even when no new public transportation infrastructure is introduced. This directly strengthens the argument by showing a clear causal link between fuel price hikes and reduced traffic, independent of public transit expansion. If congestion decreases even when transit is unchanged, it supports the claim that fuel costs, not transit improvements, drive the reduction in car usage.

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect



A. In some cities where fuel prices increased but no major improvements were made to public transit, traffic congestion still declined significantly.

This partially supports the argument but is weaker than D because it only mentions "some" cities rather than showing a broader, consistent trend. A few exceptions may not be enough to establish a strong causal link.

B. Surveys indicate that a majority of commuters who switched to public transportation cited convenience and reliability rather than financial concerns as their main reason for doing so.

This actually weakens the argument by suggesting that factors other than fuel prices, such as convenience, are the main reason for switching to public transport.

C. Cities that introduced free or heavily subsidized public transit programs saw a significant shift in commuter behavior, with more people opting for buses and trains over personal vehicles.

This suggests that public transit improvements do influence commuter behavior, which contradicts the argument that fuel prices, not transit expansion, are the key factor in reducing congestion.

E. In cities where public transportation expansion led to improved service efficiency and shorter travel times, there was a noticeable decline in personal vehicle use.

This weakens the argument by supporting the idea that better public transit directly reduces car use, which goes against the claim that fuel costs are the primary factor.

It best supports the argument that rising fuel costs, rather than public transit improvements, are the main driver of reduced traffic congestion

Q28 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: B

B. Companies that adopted fully remote work models saw an initial increase in productivity, but

after a year, many employees reported feeling disconnected and struggled with collaboration. This weakens the argument by challenging the long-term effectiveness of remote work. If productivity gains are only temporary and eventually decline due to collaboration issues, then remote work may not be as beneficial as claimed.

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect

A. Employees working remotely report spending an average of 20% of their workday on non-work-related tasks, such as household chores and personal errands.

While this suggests some inefficiencies, it does not directly refute the argument that overall productivity is higher. Employees could still be more productive despite occasional distractions.

C. A survey found that employees who had the option to work remotely or in the office performed equally well, regardless of their chosen work environment.

This is neutral rather than weakening—it suggests that remote work doesn't necessarily improve productivity, but it also doesn't prove that it harms it. The argument remains plausible.

D. Some employees working remotely reported higher job satisfaction, even when their productivity levels remained unchanged.

This addresses job satisfaction, not productivity, making it irrelevant to weakening the argument.

E. Firms that implemented hybrid work models—combining remote and in-office work—showed a greater productivity increase than those that switched to fully remote work.

This suggests that hybrid work might be better, but it does not necessarily weaken the claim that remote work is productive. It only implies that an alternative might be more effective.

It most effectively weakens the argument by showing that remote work's productivity benefits may be temporary and decline over time due to collaboration difficulties.

Q29 Text Solution:



Correct Answer: B

B. Higher wages can lead to increased consumer spending, but this effect is often temporary, as inflation adjusts prices to compensate for rising labor costs.

This weakens the argument by undermining the long-term impact of raising the minimum wage. If the increase in consumer spending is only temporary and inflation cancels out the benefits, then the argument that higher wages create sustained economic growth becomes doubtful.

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect

A. In some regions where the minimum wage was increased, businesses reduced hiring and relied more on automation, leading to a decline in job availability.

While this suggests potential downsides of raising the minimum wage, it does not directly refute the argument that wage increases drive economic growth. It focuses more on employment effects rather than overall economic expansion.

C. A study found that businesses in sectors with low profit margins responded to higher wages by passing increased costs onto consumers, reducing overall demand for their goods and services.

This challenges the mechanics of the argument but does not fully disprove the idea that higher wages lead to economic growth. Consumer demand may shift rather than decline outright.

D. Countries that have maintained a relatively low minimum wage for decades, such as certain developing nations, have experienced strong economic growth driven by investment and trade rather than wage increases.

This provides an alternative path to economic growth but does not directly show that raising the minimum wage is ineffective. It suggests another strategy rather than weakening the given argument.

E. Many workers who received wage increases reported improved financial stability but did not

significantly alter their spending habits, choosing instead to save more of their earnings.

While this suggests that not all workers increase spending, it does not negate the argument that, in aggregate, higher wages drive more consumption and economic activity.

It most effectively weakens the argument by showing that the economic boost from higher wages may be short-lived due to inflation, making sustained growth uncertain

Q30 Text Solution:

Correct Answer: A

A. Several large companies that adopted a four-day workweek reported an increase in revenue per employee while maintaining or even improving customer satisfaction levels.

This directly strengthens the argument by providing concrete evidence that companies with a four-day workweek experience increased profitability and sustained customer satisfaction—key factors supporting the claim that the model is beneficial.

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect

B. A survey found that employees working a four-day schedule reported higher job satisfaction, but their overall output per week remained similar to that of a five-day schedule. While this supports job satisfaction, it does not prove an increase in productivity or profitability. If output remains the same, there's no clear financial advantage for businesses.

C. Studies show that employees in organizations with flexible work schedules, including four-day workweeks, are more likely to stay with their employers long-term, reducing hiring and training costs.

This suggests a potential long-term benefit, but it does not directly confirm increased productivity or profitability. The link is indirect.

D. Some industries, particularly in the technology and creative sectors, have seen improvements in innovation and project completion rates after shifting to a four-day workweek.



This is industry-specific and does not apply broadly. The argument is about overall productivity and profitability, not just select fields.

E. In countries where shorter workweeks are common, national productivity levels per hour worked tend to be higher than in countries with longer workweeks.

This establishes a correlation but does not necessarily imply causation for individual companies. National trends may be influenced by multiple factors beyond the workweek structure. It most effectively strengthens the argument by directly demonstrating increased revenue and sustained customer satisfaction, which align with the core claim that a four-day workweek benefits companies.



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